There was more drama to come. On 10 November, Tata Sons issued a nine-page statement giving its reasons for taking the extraordinary decision to remove Mistry. It highlighted eight important issues in as many sections. It rebutted all the allegations that Mistry had made in the mail he had sent to the directors of Tata Sons and the trustees of Tata Trusts.

The trope of the communication was that a new chairman had to be found because of Mistry's inability to provide sound leadership to the group and successfully deal with the challenges a conglomerate of this size and complexity was often called upon to meet. This aspect was also commented upon by independent observers. He had to leave 'amid what had been growing dissatisfaction with his performance', commented *The Times*, London.

The statement underscored that Mistry had nothing to show as his contribution towards creating wealth for the shareholders. The dividends paid to Tata Sons by the forty companies, excluding TCS, in the affairs of which he played virtually no role, without the additional interim dividend paid due to budgetary changes, had declined by 32 per cent during his stewardship (2012–13 to 2015–16). Furthermore, during his tenure, the group indebtedness had risen by nearly 45 per cent (during the period March 2012–March 2016) and the market share of Tata Motors had declined substantially. Even before making provisions for impairment (when the market value of the assets of a company is less than the value assigned in the company's balance sheet), if it were not for TCS, Tata Sons would have suffered operational losses during the same period. And to cover up for his lacklustre performance Mistry had used the strong network of the group to divert attention by constantly harping on his favourite themes of 'hot spots'.

The statement underscored that 50 per cent of the group's turnover and 90 per cent of its profits were on account of TCS and JLR. While Mistry could contribute virtually nothing to the former, the latter was acquired by Ratan. It also completely denied that Tata Trusts was interfering in the working of Tata Sons and its companies. It asserted that the Trusts were created by the founder and his relatives by donating large sums for charity. These investments were in Tata Sons.The income from the Tata companies was the main source of funding for the philanthropic activities of the Trusts. The Trusts were concerned about the decreasing income from the companies other than TCS and it was in this context that it was keeping